

G06 — Reported Speech

Le discours indirect

 17 S4 — Cours 3	 B1-B2	 marc.vasseur@polytech-lille.fr
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📌 Le discours indirect rapporte ce que quelqu'un a dit sans utiliser ses mots exacts. Temps, pronoms et repères temporels changent.

1. Concordance des temps (Backshift)

DISCOURS DIRECT	DISCOURS INDIRECT
Present Simple : 'I work'	Past Simple : he said he worked
Present Continuous : 'I am working'	Past Continuous : he was working
Past Simple : 'I worked'	Past Perfect : he had worked
Present Perfect : 'I have worked'	Past Perfect : he had worked
Will : 'I will come'	Would : he would come
Can : 'I can help'	Could : he could help
Must : 'I must go'	Had to : he had to go
May : 'I may be late'	Might : he might be late

2. Changements de repères temporels

DIRECT	INDIRECT
today	that day
yesterday	the day before / the previous day
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
now	then / at that moment
here	there
this / these	that / those
last week	the week before
next week	the following week
ago	before / previously

3. Questions indirectes

Structure	Anglais	Note
Yes/No	She asked if/whether he was coming.	if/whether — pas d'inversion — pas de ?
Wh-	He asked where she lived.	wh- + ordre sujet-verbe (pas d'inversion) — pas de ?

⚠ **JAMAIS de point d'interrogation dans une question indirecte. Pas d'auxiliaire Do/Does/Did.**

4. Say vs Tell

Structure	Anglais	Note
SAY	She said (that)... / He said to me that...	Say ne prend PAS d'objet personnel direct
TELL	She told me... / He told us...	Tell DOIT avoir un objet personnel (me, him, us...)

⚠ **'She said me...' = FAUX. 'She told that...' = FAUX. 'She told me...' = CORRECT.**

🧠 **Le temps recule d'un cran : Présent → Passé / Passé → Past Perfect / Will → Would / Can → Could.**



EXERCICES GUIDÉS

Transforme au discours indirect. Attention aux backshifts et changements de repères.

Série guidée A — Statements

💡 **Said (that) + temps qui recule d'un cran / Pronoms changent / Repères temporels changent**

- 'I am very tired,' she said. → She said _____.
→ am → was
→ _____
- 'We will finish tomorrow,' he told me. → He told me _____.
→ will → would / tomorrow → the next day
→ _____
- 'I have already sent the report,' she said. → She said _____.
→ PP → Past Perfect
→ _____
- 'I don't understand the question,' he said. → He said _____.
→ Present → Past
→ _____
- 'The meeting is starting now,' she told us. → She told us _____.
→ Continuous → Past Continuous / now → then
→ _____
- 'I can help you with this,' he said. → He said _____.
→ can → could
→ _____
- 'We must submit the form today,' the manager said. → The manager said _____.
→ must → had to / today → that day

→ _____

8. 'I worked here for ten years,' she told them. → She told them _____.

→ Past → Past Perfect

→ _____

9. 'The company may relocate next year,' he said. → He said _____.

→ may → might / next year → the following year

→ _____

10. 'I have been working on this since January,' he said. → He said _____.

→ PP Continuous → Past Perfect Continuous

→ _____

Série guidée B — Questions indirectes

💡 Yes/No → if/whether + sujet + verbe (pas d'inversion) / Wh- → wh- + sujet + verbe / Pas de ?

11. 'Are you coming to the meeting?' she asked. → She asked _____.

→ Yes/No → if + sujet + verbe

→ _____

12. 'Where do you live?' he asked me. → He asked me _____.

→ where + sujet + verbe / do disparaît

→ _____

13. 'What time does the conference start?' she asked. → She asked _____.

→ what time + sujet + verbe

→ _____

14. 'Have you finished the project?' he asked. → He asked _____.

→ if + Past Perfect

→ _____

15. 'Why didn't you attend the lecture?' she asked. → She asked _____.

→ why + Past Perfect

→ _____

16. 'How long have you worked here?' he asked. → He asked _____.

→ how long + Past Perfect

→ _____

17. 'Can you speak Japanese?' she asked. → She asked _____.

→ if + could

→ _____

18. 'Who sent the email?' the director asked. → The director asked _____.

→ who (sujet) + Past Simple

→ _____

19. 'What will you do if the system fails?' she asked. → She asked _____.

→ what + would + sujet + do

→ _____

20. 'Did anyone notice the error?' he asked. → He asked _____.

→ if + anyone + had noticed

→ _____

EXERCICES — NIVEAUX A → B2+

Transforme au discours indirect.

Niveau A — Statements de base (B1)

1. 'I work here every day,' he said.
→ _____
2. 'We are building a new factory,' she told us.
→ _____
3. 'I can help you with the project,' he said.
→ _____
4. 'I passed the exam,' she said.
→ _____
5. 'The results will be ready tomorrow,' he told me.
→ _____
6. 'I had already finished when you called,' she said.
→ _____
7. 'We must submit the report by Friday,' the manager said.
→ _____
8. 'I don't know the answer,' he admitted.
→ _____
9. 'She will be promoted next month,' the director told us.
→ _____
10. 'I have been working on this for three weeks,' he said.
→ _____

Niveau B — Questions indirectes (B1+)

11. 'Are you studying for the test?' she asked me.
→ _____
12. 'Where does he work?' I asked.
→ _____
13. 'What time did the meeting start?' she asked.
→ _____
14. 'Have you ever been to Japan?' he asked me.
→ _____
15. 'Why aren't you attending the class?' she asked.
→ _____
16. 'Don't forget your badge,' she told me.
→ _____
17. 'Can you explain the results?' he asked.
→ _____
18. 'We were testing the equipment when it broke,' they said.
→ _____
19. 'I'll call you back later,' she promised.
→ _____
20. 'The company has just announced its new policy,' the CEO said.

→ _____

Niveau C — Erreurs et nuances (B1+–B2)

→ Corrige les erreurs.

21. She said me she was tired. → _____

→ _____

22. He told that he had finished. → _____

→ _____

23. She asked where did I work. → _____

→ _____

24. He said he will call back. → _____

→ _____

25. They asked if have we submitted the report. → _____

→ _____

Niveau D — Production complexe (B2+)

→ Rapporte ce dialogue au discours indirect en un paragraphe cohérent.

26. Manager: 'Have you finished the quarterly report?' / Employee: 'Not yet. I need two more hours.'

→ _____

27. Manager: 'Can you make sure it's ready by 5 PM?' / Employee: 'I'll try my best. I've been working on the data all morning.'

→ _____

28. Manager: 'Why didn't you start it earlier this week?' / Employee: 'I had other urgent priorities.'

→ _____

Score : _____ / 28 points

★ ★ Bonus — Verbes introducteurs variés

Utilise un verbe introducteur varié (admit, warn, suggest, promise, insist, explain, deny, claim, complain, remind) pour rapporter ces phrases.

→ 'I didn't take the file,' he said. → He _____

Réponse : _____

→ 'You should back up your data,' she said. → She _____

Réponse : _____

→ 'I'll deliver the project on time,' he said. → He _____

Réponse : _____

→ 'This process is too slow,' she said. → She _____

Réponse : _____

→ 'Don't touch that button!' she said. → She _____

Réponse : _____



DEVOIR MAISON

Nom & Prénom : _____

Groupe : _____

Date rendu : _____



Transforme au discours indirect.



Correction envoyée via WhatsApp la semaine prochaine.

1. 'I am preparing my presentation,' she said.

→ _____

2. 'We finished the analysis yesterday,' he told me.

→ _____

3. 'Will you attend the conference?' she asked me.

→ _____

4. 'I have never failed to meet a deadline,' he said.

→ _____

5. 'Where did you study engineering?' she asked.

→ _____

6. 'The deadline is next Monday,' the manager told us.

→ _____

7. 'I can't find the relevant file,' he said.

→ _____

8. 'Are you happy with the current results?' she asked.

→ _____

9. 'We had already solved the problem before you arrived,' they said.

→ _____

10. 'Don't submit the report without checking it first,' he told me.

→ _____

11. 'Why have you changed the methodology?' the supervisor asked.

→ _____

12. 'I'll send you the data as soon as I can,' she promised.

→ _____

13. 'We may need to postpone the launch,' the CEO admitted.

→ _____

14. 'How many experiments have you run so far?' he asked.

→ _____

15. 'I was working on the prototype when the fire alarm went off,' she said.

→ _____

Score : _____ / 15 points